

A

a- / (N.K.) **ma-**, conc. prefix (U), n., a., & p.c. cl. 2.

a / **ma**, interrog. pron. (U), ref. to cl. 2, who (exactly)?, which people?; *nĩ ~ moka?*, *nĩ ~ na ~?*, *nĩ tũirĩtu na tũhũ*, who precisely came?, who and who?, the little girls and boys; *nĩ inyuĩ ~?*, *inyuĩ nĩ ~?*, who are you?; *nĩ ~ aya!*, shame on you, what sort of people do you think you are!

-a, part. (U), indic. relationship, association, or possession, preceded by the p.c. of all classes; the meaning is expr. by var. prep. as well as the poss. in English; *nguo ci~Kamau*, K's clothes; *njĩra y~ rũũ*, the path to the river; *mũgũnda w~ kĩanda*, a garden in a valley; *cira w~ githaka*, a case about land; *akĩmũtheca itimũ rĩ~ nda*, he stabbed him with a spear in the stomach; *nĩ h~ rũmbo*, it is a dancing place; see also *ha*; *nĩ kw~ riũa mũno*, it is a very hot country; see also *kwa*.

-a-, v. infix (U), sign of the immediate past tenses.

a' / **aa** [aa-a], interj. (U), expr. deep disapproval, disgust, irritation; ~, *thũ na kũu*, Oh, for heaven's sake, go away!

aa, pers. collective part. (U), those with, those belonging to, the associates of, the crowd with; *twarĩra ~ Kamau*, take it to K. and the people with him; *nao ~ Njeri makĩnũka*, N. and her crowd went home; ~ *baba*, father and his brothers, his initiation mates, father and anyone who happens to be with him at the time; ~ *Macaria*, M. and his companions; see **-a**.

aana, interj. (U), (N.K.) expr. disapproval, refusal to believe often accompanied by gesture of erect forefinger in face of person addressed (usually only a younger person).

aaĩ, see **naaĩ**.

aba / **abai'**, interj. (U), expr. dis-

approval of an action, or warning; ~ *rĩrĩa baba ariũka nĩũrĩmenya!*, my! when father comes you will get it thick!; ~ *ndikwĩre!*, I told you so, clever-Dick!; cf. *wee*.

abababa-ĩ [aabababaa-ĩ], interj. (U), expr. surprise, consternation, or mild annoyance; ~, *mbembe ici ti njiaru!*, well, well, this maize isn't bearing yet; cf. *a'*.

Abaci, see **Habaci**.

abai', n. cl. 1/2 (III), used in ref. to one's father, or addressed familiarly to another male; ~ *atarĩ ho gũtirĩ kindũ kingiuma mũcũ ũyũ*, in Dad's absence nothing shall be taken from this homestead; ~ *nĩtũthũ*, (said even to a boy companion) come on, Dad, let's be off!

abaita / **aboita**, interj. (U), expr. surprise coupled with indignation.

abando / **abondo** / **abandothi** / **abondothic'**, interj. (U), an obscene cursing expression; cf. *abaita*, *aba*.

abo, interj. (U), 1. used by women in conjunction with names, praise names associated with various clans and the word 'baba' (q.v.), as a mild form of oath or to express surprise, consternation, or indignation; ~ *Angarĩ aitũ*, *kaĩ ndĩ ngombo!*, good heavens, by the community of my clan Angarĩ, am I a slave?; ~ *baba*, *ndigũthũ*, by my father, I will not go! 2. used with the foll. forms of clan names: Angarĩ, ~ *Ngarĩ*; Anjirũ, ~ *Njirũ*; Aceera, ~ *Njeeri*; Agacikũ, ~ *Njikũ*; Ambũi, ~ *Mbũi*; Ethaga, ~ *Mbura*; Aithirandũ, ~ *Ithĩra*; Angũi, ~ *Ngũi*; Aicakamũyũ, ~ *Mũyũ*; Airimũ, ~ *Irimũ*.

aboita, see **abaita**.

aca [aaca], part. (U), (expr. negation) no; ~ *noguo* (*nĩguo*), indeed there is no doubt about it; ~-*nĩ*, (said to more than one person) certainly not!; cf. *aĩ*, *naaĩ*.

rũacũ, **njacũ**¹, n. (II), 1. chip, shiver, splinter; cf. *rũkaracũ*, *rũcacũ*. 2. thin wand as used for partition; see

rūhirigo. 3. long piece of split sugar-cane suitable for children; cf. *rūbūa*. [see *acūka*]

acūhia, see **icūhia**.

acūka, v.i. (II), (of foodstuffs) be just right, be in good condition for eating, be crisp, ripe, mellow, &c.; (of sugar-cane) be succulent, crisp, easily broken, ripe; (of beverages) taste well, be mellow; (of bread) be light, well cooked; (of soil) be dry, friable, in good condition for digging; cf. *ondoka*. *acaacūka*, dim. *acūkanga*, diff. *acūkanira*, assoc. *acūkia*, caus.; *kabura kau niko gaacūkitie igwa*, that light rain has mellowed the sugar-cane. **acūra**, v.t. 1. make just right; make crisp, ripe, mellow; *aria maanj~ga*, those who were giving me pleasure. 2. make (soil) dry, cracked.

-acūku, a. (II), mellow, crisp, ripe; *mündū mw~*, *wa ngoro nj~*, a bright, cheerful person. [*acūka*]

-ag⁻¹, v. infix, indic. the habitual aspect of an action in past, present, or future time; *nimaathom~a*, they were regular students (in the past).

-ag⁻², v. root extension, indic. an action that takes place while sth. else is happening; *rut~a wira*, get on with your work, we are going to leave you; *thi~a*, go on, I will follow.

aga, v.t. & i. (II), 1. lack, miss, fail to find; be in need of; be missing; *~mwikire*, be at a loss to know what to do; *~tha* (*bata*, *kiene*, *rūbutu*), see under *tha*, &c.; *~matū*, see under *matū*; *~thoni* (*rūbutu*), see under *thoni*; *~mündū*, give no consideration to sb.; ignore, treat with contempt. 2. (used as aux. v. in neg. sentences) *kw~kuura irio itikūra*, if it does not rain, the crops will not grow; *kw~ūguo ndithiū*, failing this I shall not go; cf. *rega*, *tiga*. **agaaga**, dim. **aganga**, diff. **agana**, rec. miss one another, fail to meet; treat each other contemptuously. *Itina na thi iti~ga*, the buttocks and the ground cannot miss one another for ever (i.e. one is bound to come to rest some time). **aganira**, rec. app. **agia**, caus. make miss, cause not to have or find sth., deprive sth.; *~gikaro*, cause not to have an abode, rest, peace. **īagia**, caus. refl. deprive oneself of; *~hinya*, wear oneself out. **agithia**, d. caus.

cause sb. to lack or miss sth., deprive sb. of sth.; *~mündū gitiño*, cause a person to miss esteem, belittle. **agika**, st. pot. **agira²**, app. fail to find for; be without sth. for or at. **īagira**, refl. app.; *~bata*, feel worthless.

mwaga¹, **a-**, n. (v), (only used in compound nouns) one who lacks: 1. *~hinya*, weak, powerless, person. 2. *~iri*, (term of abuse) one without possessions or progeny; cf. *mūimwoni-iri*. 3. *~thoni*, one who lacks modesty, ill-mannered, disrespectful, person; cf. *mūūra-thoni*. 4. *~tha*, one without compassion, humane feelings, pity. **waga**, n. cl. 14 (only in compounds): 1. *~hinya*, weakness. 2. *~thoni*, shamelessness, immodesty, rudeness, lack of manners; cf. *rūtū-riko*. 3. *~tha*, mercilessness, callousness. [*aga*]

mwaga², n. (v), condition of being single; *-a ~*, odd, left over, extra; *mündū wa ~*, odd man out; *kindū kia ~*, the extra unit in an odd number; *wira wa ~*, an extra piece of work not included in the main task; cf. *mwaha*.

rūaga, (**ndwaga**), n. (II), 1. a rack. 2. a gap; *~ini*, empty, uninhabited country. **kīaga¹**, (**ci-**), n. aug. of above.

kīaga², **ci-**, n. (II), enclosure, shed; little hut, shelter at the gate for watching over cattle; bail, stall; cage round a young tree for protection; *~kia ng'ombe*, milking enclosure; *~kia ngūkū*, fowl run. **kaaga**, **tw-**, n. dim. of above.

agaga [*agaaga*], v.i. (I), be restless, agitated, harassed, unsettled, perturbed; vacillate, move to and fro, oscillate, bob up and down, wobble about; *~(ta māi ma irūtū-ini)*, be extremely restless (as water on an arum leaf); cf. *hūga*. **agaagaga**, dim. **agaganga**, diff. **agagania**, caus. rec. make each other, others, restless, perturbed, bewildered, &c. **agaganira**, assoc. **agagia**, caus. agitate, make perturbed or restless; hurry, harass; shake (liquids); gargle; swill out (containers, utensils); *~ikombe māi*, rinse out cups with water; *~māi kanua*, gargle water in the mouth; *~kanua*, indulge in futile and wild talk; *~ūcūri kihūri-ini*,

swill gruel round in the half-calabash (before drinking or pouring out to counteract the effects of settlement); *tiga kūnj~*, don't harass me. **agagithia**, d. caus. cause restlessness, embarrassment, homelessness. **agagika**, st. pot. **agagīra**, app. vacillate in relation to; be restless, at, because of; become too much for, make perturbed, flustered; cf. *gagaira*. **agagirūo**, pass. app.; ~ *nī thī*, be at a loss to know what to do or where to go. **agagīria**, caus. app. rinse out at; shake, make restless, agitate, in, at, for.

kīagaga [*kīagaaga*], n. cl. 7 (VIII), uncertainty. [agaga]

agana, v.i. (II), be indecent, perverse; act wickedly; (of children) be naughty, mischievous, trying; cf. *ihia*, *hitia*. **agaagana**, dim. **agananga**, diff. be a general nuisance. **agania**, caus. make indecent, wicked, evil; corrupt; do evil to, wrong sb. **aganithia**, d. caus. **aganika**, st. pot. **aganīra**, app. act wickedly at; be indecent at, because of; behave wickedly, indecently, towards. **aganīria**, caus. app.

waganu, **mawaganu**, n. (IV), 1. vice, wickedness, naughtiness. 2. offence against custom, tradition, &c.; lawlessness. [agana]

-aganu, a. (III), naughty; mischievous, wicked. [agana]

agarara, v.t. (II), 1. transgress, go beyond the bounds of; pass over, miss out (by oversight or intentionally), go over the top of, surmount; cf. *atia ngata*. 2. step over (legs of a seated person, &c., this being regarded in the case of a woman as equivalent to sexual intercourse in certain rituals); cf. *tagarara*. **agarrūo**, pass. *Kahiga gākūrū gatiagararagwo nī māi*, an old stone is never passed over by water (the advice of the old is never overlooked). **agaagara-ra**, dim. **agararanga**, diff. **agararana**, rec. step, jump, over one another, others; transgress against others, one another. **agararanīra**, app. rec. **agararanīria**, caus. app. rec. lift (person, things) over sth. together. **agararia**, caus. lift over sth., cause to pass, jump, over; pass sth. over; send, throw, over. **agararithia**, d. caus. assist sb. to go over the top of sth., &c. **agararika**, st. pot. **aga-**

rarira, app. go over the top of sth., at, because of. **agarariria**, caus. app. **kīagararo**, *ci-*, n. (III), stile, pole with projecting forks for climbing over a fence. [agarara]

kīagarira, n. (IX?); *ria ~*, break a taboo, do sth. which brings ceremonial pollution on one; cf. *ng'ūki*, *thahu*. [see *agarara*]

agatha, v.i. (II), (of uncooked food esp. edible arum or unripe fruit) be of an unpleasant, bitter, stinging, taste. **agaagatha**, dim. **agathanga**, diff. **agathia**, caus. make unpleasant to taste. **agathika**, st. pot. **agathira**, app. become unpleasant to taste, to, at; have a bitter stinging taste at. **agathirūo**, pass. app.

rūagatha, **marūagatha**; **wagatha**, (**mawagatha**); n. (III), 1. (of partially cooked food, unripe fruit, over spiced food) unpleasant, bitter, astringent taste; cf. *kimithi*. 2. juice of edible arum or other uncooked food, applied as stimulant to external genitalia; see *thūra*. [agatha]

mwagatho, **mī-**, n. (III), getting irritated, heated about sth.; cf. *rūagatha*. [agatha]

mwagaū, **mī-**, n. (I), (N.K.) tall timber tree (*Cola* sp. near *laurifolia*); cf. *mūthakai*.

riagayū, **ma-**, n. (XI/I), dry banana leaf; cf. *itharara*. **njagayū**, n. (I), (N.K.) bundle of dry banana leaves. **kīagayū**, *ci-*, n. aug. of above.

mwage, **mī-**, n. (III), 1. small tree (*Oncoba routedgei*). 2. wild gourd plant (*Sphaerosicyos*); cf. (N.K.) *mūhūri*, *mūigaigua*. **rīage**, **ma-**; **kīage**, *ci-*; n. 1. fruit of the above, the size of a small orange, made into snuff bottles; ball. 2. a small wild gourd which bears prolifically. *Ūrociara ta maage*, (a nuptial blessing) may you be as fruitful as wild gourd plants.

mwagi, **a-**, n. (V), needy person, one who lacks means, one without resources; cf. *mūbata*, *mūbatari*, *mūthini*. **wagi**, n. cl. 14, lack, want, poverty. [aga]

rūagi, **njagi**, n. (II), midge, gnat.

agīra, v.i. (II) be good, nice, becoming (in quality or appearance), be good-looking, look well, be suitable; be in order. **agaagīra**, dim. improve, be, become, a little better. **agaagīria**, caus. dim. make still better.

agiranga, diff. **aganīrira**, inten. rec. be mutually becoming, suited, to each other; match; be agreeable to one another, get on well together. **agīria**, caus. make good, nice, right; make suitable, becoming; put right, cause to look fine, well, pretty, beautiful. **īagīria**, refl. caus. pretend to be good; ingratiate oneself. **agīrithia**, d. caus. have sth. made suitable, good, &c. **īagīrithia**, refl. d. caus. make oneself appear becoming; ingratiate oneself; cf. **īcukumithia**. **agīrika**, st. pot. **agīrira**, app. be fitting, suitable, seemly; suit, fit (sb., sth.); be suitable to, for; be convenient, becoming to (sb., sth.); **nīkwagīrīre gwīkaga ūguo**, it behoves (us, &c.) to be doing that. **agīrīrūo**, pass. app. (esp. in past tense with perfect) ought; **kūrī maindū twagīrīrūo nī gwīka**, there are things we ought to do. **agīrīria**, caus. app. make good, suitable, fitting, for, at.

wagīrīru, n. cl. 14 (X), fitness, suitability, rightness, appropriateness. [agīra]

wagīru, n. cl. 14 (IV), niceness, beauty, goodness, prettiness. [agīra]

mwago¹, **mī-**, n. (III), anything pleasing to the eye, anything pretty, striking, bizarre; spectacle, display, splendour; anything wonderful; excitement, fun, humour; **mwenda-**, one who loves such things. [see agīra]

nwago² (N.K.) / **mwagū, mī-**, n. (III), a climber (*Chrysophyllum fulvum*); cf. **mūniathi**.

agu / **agui**, ~; (N.K.) **wagu** / **wagui**, **ma-**; n. cl. 1/2 (III), my grandfather; ~we, ~guo, his, your, grandfather; cf. **guka**. **aagu**, n. cl. 2 only, early age grade or ruling generation, early ancestors; **kuuma (kinya, gwata) ~ na ~**, from time immemorial; **kuuma ~ kinya mindī na mindī**, from everlasting to everlasting; cf. **tene, mindī**. [cf. Ma. OL-AKWI]

-**agu**, a. (IV), missing, lacking; **ng'ombe nī nj~**, the cows cannot be found. [aga]

agura / **gura**, v.i. (II), be rude, impolite; (of a child) be a nuisance, cry relentlessly. **agaagura**, dim. **aguranga**, diff. **agurira**, app. cry for.

aha, v.i. & t. (II), 1. gape, be agape for; (of dogs, &c.) hold mouth open (to

snap at flies); ~ **rūhuho**, (of door) be wide open to the breeze. 2. (of people) seek food when starving, look for sth. to eat or drink; **athuuri acio matindaga maki~ njohi**, those elders spend the whole day hunting for drink. 3. take a snack; cf. **īgagūra, ītua nyoni**. 4. yawn, swallow up, engulf. 5. (of river) overflow, spread out and engulf. **ahaaha**, dim. **ahaahūra**, conv. dim. **ahahūka**, neut. dim. **ahanga**, diff. **ahanira**, app. rec. go out together in search of. **ahaniria**, caus. app. rec. search for sth. together with sth. else. **ahia**, caus. cause to engage in greedy or acquisitive quest; **uuma kw~ nda ino kū?**, where have you been seeking to fill this maw of yours?; ~ **maitho rūgongo rūria**, cast your eyes over yonder ridge. **ahithia**, d. caus. help sb. to get a snack; assist sth. to acquire sth. **ahika**, st. pot.; **thaa īgūkinya hau gūtingi~**, food is unobtainable at this hour of the day. **ahikika**, d. st. pot. **ahikira**, app. st. pot. **ahira**, app. get a snack for; **ndwahire arata aku**, get sth. to eat for your friends. **iahira**, refl. app.; **tiga kw~ rorania na ciana!**, enough of filling your belly, attend to the children now! **ahiria**, caus. app. appropriate, make free with, filch (food, beer, &c., meant for others), intercept what is passed round. **ahūra**, conv. 1. break off (branch or twig at bifurcation); divide up, strip off (bananas from a bunch), wrench off (a limb from a sheep carcass); cf. **kahūra, kohora**. 2. make a fork, diversion, branch, path, or by-pass leading off an existing one. 3. take in an additional area of uncultivated land to enlarge a garden. **ahūranga**, diff. conv. **ahūrana**, rec. conv. **ahūrania**, caus. rec. conv. strip apart, wrench into separate parts. **ahūranira**, app. rec. conv. **ahūrithia**, d. caus. conv. **ahūrika**, st. pot. conv. **ahūrira**, app. conv. **ahūrīrira**, inten. app. conv. **ahūka**, neut. 1. (of branch or twig at bifurcation) break off; (of banana from a bunch, &c.) split, fall off; **gicunji kimwe giki~ kīama-ini**, one group seceded from the Council; cf. **kohoka**. 2. branch off, turn off, change direction at a fork in a path; (N.K.) make way, stand on one side; cf. **ehūka, kerūra**. **ahūkanga**, diff. neut. **ahū-**

kana, rec. neut. be divided, split off, fork, become split off (as water encountering a barrier). **ahūkanīra**, assoc. neut. **ahūkika**, st. pot. neut. **ahūkira**, app. neut. branch off, at, because of; get split off and fall on to. **aha**, interj. (I), expr. disgust, disapproval, disappointment, or annoyance.

mwaha, n. cl. 3 only (III); -a ~, odd single; cf. *mwaga*. [aha]

riaha, **ma**⁻¹, n. (III), 1. one side of a fork; cf. *rūhūang'a*. 2. flank of a slaughtered sheep, goat, or ox; cf. *ikengeto*. [aha]

maaha², n. cl. 6 only (III), 1. products of sth.; progeny, offspring; *ūroaga* ~, may you lack children to your name; *e na* ~ *maingi*, he has plenty of resources (personal or material). 2. snack; cf. *kandū*. 3. gratuity (usually in the form of food given over and above a payment; cf. *mbacici*. 4. bifurcation; a branched yam tuber. [aha]

ahaa, interj. (I), expr. delight or comprehension, tolerant dissent or kindly correction; cf. *ihii*, *ohoo*.

ahuha [ahuuha], v.t. & i. (I'), 1. sniff (wind), snuff. 2. (of hyena, dog, &c.) seek for scent, forage about for, quest, nose around; cf. *nuha*. **ahuhanga**, diff. **ahuhania**, caus. rec. nose around, prowl, together. **ahuhanira**, assoc. **ahuhia**, caus. **ahuhithia**, d. caus. **ahuhika**, st. pot. nose about, prowl around (as if seeking for sth.), pry about. **ahuhira**, app.

mwahuha [mwahuuha], **mī**-, n. (VIII), a yawning hole, cavity, gap, breach, tunnel; a dog's nose, the mouth of an elephant's trunk; *eheria* ~ *ūyū haha*, take your snout away; cf. *mwanya*. [ahuha]

-ahuhi [-ahuuhi], a. (I), restless; *mündū mw*~, one who noses about, a 'Nosy Parker'. [ahuha]

mwahuhiko [mwahuuhiko], **mī**-, n. (I), habit of nosing about; cf. *mūcene-neko*. [ahuha]

mwahunga, **mī**-, n. (IV), a yawning hole, tunnel, wide opening, or crack; cf. *mwahuha*.

mwaha, **mī**-, n. (V), hand of bananas; cf. *gīkahū*, *irigū*. **rūahū**, **njahū**, n. part of a hand of bananas; strip of sth., piece broken off, portion. **kīahū**, **cī**-, n. 1. aug. of above. 2. fork,

branch; ~-*inī*, aside, *mama wa* ~-*inī*, pseudo-uncle (term of relationship used by children to the brother of their mother's co-wife); cf. *mwena*. **kīrūahū**, **i**-, n. long strip of sth. [aha] **maahūkanīro** / **maahūkanira**, n. cl. 6 only (III), point of divergence; bifurcation, place where a road, path, forks, ~ *ma njira*, cross-road, junction, fork. [aha]

ai¹, dem. (U), ref. to cl. 10 nouns only, these; (used by old people, to accompaniment of finger signs) *mbūri nī* ~ *inya*, the goats number—four; see *ici*. **ai**² / **aic'** / **aicū**, interj. (U), used when one has heard sth. obviously untrue; cf. *hai* / *haic'* / *haicū*.

mwai, **a**-, n. (I), wood-carver; ~ *wa itī*, stool-maker; ~ *wa mwatū*, hive-maker; ~ *wa ndebe*, maker of wooden ear ornaments; ~ *wa ndirī*, maker of mortars. **wai**, n. cl. 14, wood-carving. [aya]

-aitū (N.K.), see **-itū**.

aiya-ya-ya-ya, interj. (U), used 1. as a warning to scare birds from a field. 2. in deprecation, remonstrance, or dismay; ~, *nūū weka ūguo?*, I say, who has done that?

mwaiyo, **mī**-, n. (I), widespreading scandent tree (*Trichocladus ellipticus*); cf. *mūrendera*.

ai, occasional var. of **ūī**, only with 3rd pers.; see **ūī**.

aikania, v.t. (I), perform ceremony to promote fertility in brides and women generally.

riāiro, **ma**-, **kīāiro**, **cī**-, n. (I), place where stools, bee-barrels, &c., are carved; cf. *kīea*. [aya]

aiwa / **ayūwa** / (N.K.) **wayūa** [wayūwa], n. (XI), sacrum of animal; *ngoima ya* ~, ram given to mother-in-law by son-in-law as traditional present; cf. *rūcuthi*; see **rūa**.

aka, v.t. (II), build, make, construct; ~ *mündū*, dominate a person. **īaka**, refl. settle oneself in comfort; give an impression of being self-contained. **akaaka**, dim. **akanga**, diff. **akania**, caus. rec. build close to someone else; build anyhow. **akanira**, app. rec. build together at the same time. **īakia** refl. build homestead away from others, dwell alone. **akithia**, d. caus. have built, help to build. **akithiria**, caus. app. have built for, at. **akika**, st. pot. **akikira**, app. st. pot. **akira**,

app. build for, at. *īakīra*, refl. app. *akiria*, caus. app. have sth. enclosed (in the mouth). *akirīra*, inten. build alongside sth., extend a building. *akūra*, conv. dismantle, pull down (a building), demolish; cf. *tharia*. *īakūra*, refl. conv. *akūrithia*, d. caus. conv. *akūrika*, st. pot. conv. *akūrira*, app. conv. *akūka*, neut. be, become, dismantled.

mwaka, mī-, n. (III), 1. year; ~ *wa mirongo īrī*, 1920. 2. season; the names of the main divisions and their order vary according to altitude and local vagaries of climate; those set out here follow approximately chronological order where there are two growing seasons; see dictionary entries. 1. early part of the year: *mūgaa*, *kagaa*, *kīnjangwe*, *mwaniathenge*. 2. March to May: *mbura-yanjahi*, *mūringo*, *kīhu*, *gīthananwa*, *mūgira-njara*. 3. June to August: *mūthaatū*, *gathaatū*, *muoria-nyoni*, *gaciciū*, *gathano*, *mūthano-mūmū*, (N.K.) *gathano-komū*. 4. September to December: *mbura-ya-mwere*, *mūringo*, *īrera-hūngū*, *kanya-hūngū*, *kīya-kia-mūhia* (mwere), *kaya-karongo*, *kīhu*, *gīthananwa*, *mūratho*, *njakoirā*, *thano*, *themithū*, *gatumu* (tumu); cf. *kīmera*, *hīndī*, *kahinda*.

mwakano, mī-, n. (I), blaze, flare up, heat; anger, indignation; severe pain. **njakano, ~**, n. 1. sharp pain (less severe than above). 2. (coll.) poking fun at sb. or one another; 'sitting on', attacking, insinuating things about, one another. [akia]

-ake, p.a. (U), poss. a. & pron. his; her, hers.

mwaki¹, a-, n. (III), builder, mason. [aka]

mwaki², mī-, n. (I), 1. fire; *īkīra ūhorō* ~, make sth. more urgent or arresting; *ota* ~, see under *ota*, cf. *thiata*; *ria* ~, enjoy oneself, be out for a spree; nicknamed (N.K.) *mwarī-wandune*. 2. a territorial unit of several villages; *andū a ~ ūmwē*, people of a fire-linked unit; *kīama kīa* ~, see under *kīama*. [see akia]

akia, v.t. (I), light (a fire, lamp, &c.), turn on (electric light); cf. *mundia*, *gwatia*. **akangia**, diff. **akana**, rec. burn, light up, be lighted; (of lights) be on, shine. **akanwo**, pass. rec.; ~ *nī ngoro*, become incensed with

indignation. **akania**, caus. rec. **akanira**, app. rec. **akaniria**, caus. app. rec. **akithia**, d. caus. **akika**, st. pot. **akiria**, app. light for. **akiriria**, inten. stoke up (a fire), keep up (a fire) for sb.; ~ *nyūngū īō ū rūiko*, keep up the fire for the pot on the stove, exaggerate a story.

maakira, n. with cl. 14 concords (III), (N.K.) glutton; see *akiria*.

mwakire, mī-, n. (IV), manner, style, of building; way in which a structure has been or is being built. [aka]

mwako, mī-, n. (III), building in course of erection; process of house-building; *rūciū nītūgathū ~ gwa Kanyī*, tomorrow we shall go to assist in the erection of a house at K.'s; *tua* ~, cut poles, grass, &c., collect materials for building a hut or house. **wako, mawako**, n. piece of land on which to settle, building site; *hoya* ~, apply for a piece of land on which to settle. [aka] **akorūo**, see under *kora*.

-aku, p.a. (U), poss. a. & pron. 2nd pers. s., (thy) your, (thine) yours.

-akwa, p.a. (U), poss. a. & pron., my, mine; see also *-wa*.

kīama¹, ci-, n. (I), those set apart as a council, council of elders; council, tribunal, association, party, committee; a deliberative, advisory, legislative, judicial, or executive body in a country, province, district, ridge, or village; the graduated system of eldership for which Kikuyu married men become eligible; ~ *gīa kamatimū*, the first grade of elders composed of recently married men with at least one child (admitted on payment of a goat or sheep, and carrying spears instead of staves of office, who serve as assistants in the court as part of their training but are not entitled to judge a case, though they provide the core of the army); see *njama ya ita*; cf. (N.K.) *mūranja*; ~ *kīa mbūri imwe*, ~ *kīria kinyinyi*, ~ *kīa mūthigi*, lower degree of the 'kīama' proper (carrying unblackened staff and leaves loosely tied); ~ *kīa matathi*, also ~ *kīria kīnene*, ~ *gīa athamaki*, ~ *kīria gīkūrū*, ~ *kīa njoho*, ~ *kīa būrūri*, (Ndia) ~ *gīa itūiro*, 'kīama' proper, council of senior elders (the highest territorial body with judicial and administrative functions, composed of those who possess initiated children,

carrying a blackened staff, as symbol of office *see* *matathi*); ~ *kīa maturanguru*, the inner circle of the council of senior elders with the highest religious and political authority, carrying 'maturanguru' (q.v.) and wearing 'icūhi' (q.v.), also (N.K.) ~ *gīa kirogo* (because of their power to put a curse on any one who persists in defying their decisions or orders); ~ *kīa ihiga*, tribunal court, tribunal; ~ *gīa atumia*, women's guild; ~ *kīa Barūthi* (Ngabana), Governor's Executive Council, also Legislative Council; ~ *kīa mbūkīra*, an emergency council; ~ *kīa ahūri mūbira*, football league; ~ *kīa ndundu*, secret or private council, confidential committee, inner circle; ~ *gīa itūūra*, village council; ~ *kīa rūgongo*, ridge or location council; ~ *kīa mwaki*, council of a fire-linked unit or group of villages; ~ *kīa būrūri*, inter-district or country-wide council; ~ *kīa ūteti*, a political party or association; ~ *kīa aruti a wira*, trade union; ~ *kīa endia a irio*, food-sellers' co-operative society; ~ *gīa kanitha*, the governing body of a church. *mūkīama*, *a-*, n. member of the council of elders; member of any council or committee.

*kīama*², *ci-*, n. (I), miracle, marvel, marvellous occurrence; trick, sleight of hand; puzzle; *ringa* ~, *see* *ringa*.

kīama-ita, *ci-*, n. (v), tactless go-between who causes trouble; cf. *mūhuhī-mūimbīa*.

ame, interj. [U], expr. surprise; ~! *ūria ūrithitie mūgūnda ūyū nūū?*, tch! tch! who has let the cattle into this garden? [*see* *arūme*]

amī-amī-amī, interj. (U), a sacrificial incantation; cf. *thai*.

kīamori, *see* *mori*.

amu, conj. (U), for, because; cf. *tondū*. [cf. *Ma. AMU*]

amuma [*amuuma*], v.i. (I), (of cattle) be restless; cf. *anūka*, *rarama*.

riamuma [*riamuuma*], (*ma-*); *mwamuma* (*mī-*); n. (I), (of cattle) restlessness. [*amuma*]

mwamū, *mī-*, n. (v), apartness, separation, state of being set apart; *tūūra* ~, dwell apart; *iga indo ici* ~, put these things aside; -*a* ~, ~-*i*, ~-*rī* ~, separate; cf. *mwanya*; *mīamū ya andū*, individuals; cf. *mūng'ang'a*. [*amūra*]

mwamūkanīro, *mī-*, n. (I), reci-

procity. *Kanya* (*Koiga*) *gatune nī* ~, the little red snuff-box (calabash) is a symbol of mutual giving and receiving. [*amūkīra*]

mwamūkano, *mī-*; *nyamūkano*, ~; n. (III), act of separating one from another, separation, schism, secession; forking, division, junction of road; cf. *njahūkano*, *njatūkano*. *wamūkano*, n. cl. 14 only, state of separation (mainly of living things), division; cf. *watūkano*. [*amūka*]

*amūkīra*², v.t. & i. (I), receive (from another), accept, take what is offered; cf. *iŷūkīa*; ~ *mūgeni*, give hospitality to a stranger or guest. *amūkīranga*, diff. *amūkanīra*, rec. receive or accept others, receive each other. *amūkanīria*, caus. rec. receive together. *amūkīria*, caus. 1. take up, join in, respond to, answer (a cry of alarm, &c.); cf. *itika mbu*. 2. sing back refrain of a song, sing loudly; respond heartily; ~ *ta kīama gīa Cura*, assent by responding heartily without reflection; *see* *kūya*, *gathīrīria*. *amūkīrithia*, d. caus. help sb. in receiving. *amūkīrika*, st. pot. be receivable. *amūkīrīra*, app. receive, accept for, at. *amūkūra* / *amūkūria*, (N.K.), *see* *amūkīria*.

amūra, v.t. (II), set apart, set aside; consecrate, ordain. *īamūra*, refl. 1. detach oneself, separate oneself from others; stand, sit, apart. 2. dedicate oneself. *amaamūra*, dim. *amūranga*, diff. *amūrana*, rec. apportion share. *amūrania*, caus. rec. separate out (sheep from goats, &c.), segregate. *īamūrania*, refl. caus. rec.; ~ *na*, separate oneself from. *amūrithia*, d. caus. *amūrīka*, st. pot. *amūrīra*, app. set apart, separate, consecrate, for, at. *amūka*, v.i. (of goat from herd, &c.) separate, be, become, detached, separated. *amūkana*, rec. neut. *amūkanīra*, assoc. neut. *amūkīra*¹, app. get separated out at; split off because of.

*amba*¹, v.t. (I), 1. stretch, peg, out; ~ *hema*, pitch tent; ~ *mūtī igūrū*, crucify; ~ *nyambo*, plant sharpened stakes for defence, or in a game pit; ~ *mathagu*, (of birds) spread wings when at rest. 2. cast on stitches (in knitting, weaving). *īamba*, refl. *ambaamba*, dim. *ambanga*, diff. *ambana*, rec. (formerly, with ref. to

Ituika ceremony) peg anti-social persons to ground covering them with heaps of dry grass and rubbish prior to burning them to death. **ambanira**, app. rec. **ambanirira**, assoc. **ambithia**, d. caus. help to stretch, peg out. **ambika**, st. pot. **ambira**, app. **ambura**, conv. 1. take up, unpeg anything pegged down; ~ **mubira**, kick a football high in the air. 2. undo (knitting, wearing apparel, &c.). **amburuka**, neut. conv. move in a stream at a fast pace; stream out, along. **ambururuka**, neut. inten. spring up as in anger or threateningly, break out into angry resentful speech; be stirred up. **ambuka**, neut. get unpegged; become undone. **ambarara**, stc. inten. 1. stretch oneself up, stand on tiptoe; sit up, be erect. 2. be tilted up, be raised at one end or side; cf. hang'arara, andatara. 3. (of snakes, &c.) rear up, bridle up. 4. flare up, take offence. **ambararia**, caus. inten. 1. raise up, elevate; ~ **moko!**, hands up! 2. cause to take offence. **ambararia**, refl. caus. inten. 1. draw oneself up, assume erect attitude, rear up, take offence. **ambaruruka**, inten.; see **ambururuka**. **ambata**, ten. go up, come up, climb up; ~ **ngoro**, feel a rising of emotion, indignation; cf. thang'ata, haica. **ambaambata**, dim. ten. go or come up a little farther, rise a little, go on upwards. **ambatia**, caus. ten. take, bring, upwards, cause to rise, raise, hoist. **ambatira**, app. ten. go up at, along or through; go or come up higher, move upwards, raise in station, be promoted; ~ **gacira gaka**, go up along this path. **ambatiria**, caus. app. ten. **ambatirira**, inten. ten. ascend, climb up by, upon, or into; climb right up to the top. **ambatiriria**, caus. inten. ten. **amba**², v.t. & i. (I), 1. be the first, start, begin; *no ni nyambire ho*, I was the first on the spot. *Ndi-ga na magua*, (the bee) does not begin with honeycombs. *Thugo nicio ci-ga ūthoni*, ceremonial gifts form the preliminary to marriage arrangements. 2. (freq. as aux. v. foll. by inf. or subj.) (do) first; *niū wambire gūtema?*, who made the first cut?; ~ **ūthū**, first go. **ambaamba**, dim. 1. appear as if about to begin sth.; fidget, be impatient; (of birds) raise wings up and

down without leaving the ground; cf. **amba mathagu**. 2. heave, rise and fall (as in breathing). **ambaambia**, caus. dim.; *ni kī kirakw~?*, what is worrying you? **ambanga**, diff. **ambana**, rec. (esp. of quarrel, fight) start to do sth. to others, each other; start a row, go at each other. **ambanirira**, app. rec. begin to do sth. to others. **ambaniriria**, assoc. begin together; begin on, start with. **ambia**, caus. be the first to do sth., begin (with) sth.; ~ **irio**, be the first to taste food. **ambio**, pass. *Ka mwene niko kaambagio ira*, it is his own child that the householder should decorate first with white chalk (at initiation). *Mwarī wa magego ndaambagio mūcū*, a girl from a home where meat is eaten often should not be taken as a first wife. **ambika**, st. pot. used inten. start, initiate, a piece of work; make a beginning (on a piece of weaving). **ambikwo**, pass. st. pot.; *kūngano giki~ na mahoya*, the meeting was opened with prayer. **ambikira**, app. st. pot. begin to do sth., at, for, in. **ambira**, app. start to do sth., for, at; initiate (a piece of knitting, weaving, &c.) for. **ambirira**, inten. begin a succession of acts, begin to do sth. first; begin with, on, at; *ngw~ mūti ūyū*, I am going to begin with this tree (with others to come); *niwe waambiriire kūrīma kagongo gaka?*, were you the first to cultivate this bit of ridge? **ambiriria**, caus. inten. begin, start off; start up (a car, &c.). **mwamba**¹, **mī**-, n. (I), one of the four main rafters of a traditional round hut, erected to support the double ring of sticks at its top into which the upper ends of the closely set rafters are thrust; cf. (N.K.) **mūtheco**, **mūratho**. **mwamba**², **mī**-, n. (I), (coll.) a tough guy; cf. **mūci**. **rūamba**, **marūamba**, n. (VIII), 1. minute spines, prickles, stings on sugar-cane leaves, nettles, caterpillars, which irritate the skin. 2. a plant (*Hibiscus diversifolius*), wild cotton (rough with small prickles; produces natural rope). **kirūamba**, **i**-, n. 1. aug. of 1. above. 2. flower of 2. above. **mwamba-igūrū**, see **mūimba-igūrū**.

maambarita, n. cl. 6 only, (I), 1. interior of roof; cf. *mūtīrīro*. 2. space between wicker-work of grain store and its thatched roof.

mwambatīrīro, **mī-**, n. (I), upward slope, rise in the ground. [amba¹]

mwambato, **mī-**, n. (I), a rise, rising slope; a rising, going up. [amba¹]

mwambi, **a-**, n. (I), the first man to settle in an area. **rīambi**, **ma-**, n. the thin layer of unused cells outside an actual honeycomb. **kīambi**, **ci-**, n. first (of a number of things, of a batch, series, &c.); cf. *kīambiko*; see *nyakīambi*. [amba²]

mwambia, **a-**, n. (II), one who begins (e.g. in the spear-throwing game). ~ *nacio tiwe mūrigia nacio*, the one who begins things is not the one who ends up with them. [amba²]

rīambīko, **ma-**, n. (I), place, time, of commencement. **kīambīko**, **ci-**, n. point of commencement (of a piece of work, construction of article, weaving of string-bag, &c.). [amba²]

kīambīrīria, **ci-**, n. (IX), beginning, starting-point; ~ *kīa mwaka (mweri)*, beginning of year (month); ~ *ngwaci nyingi*, beginning of many sweet potatoes (said at beginning of sweet potato harvest when the harvester spits on the first potato taken up, and throws it in front of him, to ensure a good crop). [amba²]

mwambirīrio, **mī-**, n. (I), beginning; day of the week on which work begins; *mūthenya wa* ~, Monday; see *kiumia*, *mūthenya*; cf. *kīambirīria*. [amba²]

kīambīro, **ci-**, n. (I), 1. commencement; beginning of a matter, case, project. 2. dealing with, doing of, a piece of work. [amba²]

kīambo, **ci-**, n. (I), 1. a peg-stretched hide. 2. vertebra with meat attached, esp. one of the bones of the neck; ~ *kīa ūiyūkio*, section of vertebrae given to the elder to whom this part of the animal was allocated at a meat feast; ~ *kīa mūthaci*, section of vertebrae given to the man who cuts up the vertebral column; ~ *kīa ngūcū*, lines in order ready for the dance; *hūra* ~, prepare lines ready for the dance. [amba¹]

rūambo, **nyambo** / **maambo**, n. (I), 1. sharpened stick, tent peg, peg used in spreading out hides and skins to

dry. ~ *rūmwe rūtiambaga ndarūa*, one peg cannot peg out an ox-hide. 2. hole in a hide in which a peg is put. *Maitho ma arūme ti maambo*, men's eyes are not empty peg holes. [amba¹]

maambura, n. cl. 6 (I), 1. ceremonial accompanying certain 'rites de passage'; sacred rituals (including coition between the father and the mother of the homestead concerned) connected with the normal events of family life, birth, second birth, puberty, initiation, circumcision, marriage, performed under the direction of senior elders or old women, supplemented at circumcision rites by the *mündū mūgo wa* ~; *ruta* ~, perform the rituals. *Gikuū ti* ~, death is not a happy family occasion (since the bereaved may not mix with others until after the completion of the death-cleansing rites). See *igongona*. 2. (N.K.) dance of young men and women, boys and girls, on the day before a circumcision; cf. *matuumo*. 3. menstrual period (during which none of above rites could be performed); *ona* ~, menstruate; *oera mwana* ~, (of parents) perform ceremony for a girl at her first menstruation; cf. *mīruru*, *mūgongo*², *mweri*, *mūirū*, *īnenūra*, *īratha*.

rūambū, **nyambū**, n. (II), (of animal) white stomach fat, inward fat, suet; cf. *ngurunyū*, *higo*, *matere*, *ihu*, *gītaathira*.

kīambūriro, **ci-**, n. (I), small piece of meat left behind on the skin of an animal esp. at the top of the neck (in the case of a fat ram); cf. *ndaara-narūa*. [amba¹]

ana, v.i. (I), cry out (as in pain, fear, despair); roar, scream, moan, yell; *ūkū* ~ *wane!*, you'll yell (for help) in vain! **anaana**, dim. **ananga**, diff. **ananīra**, app. rec. **ananīria**, caus. app. rec. (of animals) low, bleat, for each other. **ania**¹, caus. (used inten.) cry out; (of animals) low, bleat, cry. **anithia**, d. caus. 1. make bleat, low; make cry out. 2. give sharp thrashing. 3. sound, blow, ring (bugle, horn, bell); ~ *mūcarica*, crack a whip; ~ *mbu*, sound the alarm (by yelling). **anika**, st. pot. **anira**, app. cry out, roar, yell, at, because of. **anīria**, caus. app. (of animals) bleat, low, cry for, at; long for. **anīrira**, inten. shout, cry out, cry out with a long and

sustained call (as to sb. at a distance); announce, proclaim; ~ *kīhikanio*, put up the banns. **anūra**, conv. 1. make cry out, yell, loudly. 2. give a very sharp thrashing; strike (esp. with a whip). 3. crack (whip) loudly. 4. (of animals) howl, bellow, bleat incessantly. 5. make (bugles, horns, &c.) blare. **anūka**, neut. 1. go on screaming, yelling. 2. howl; blare.

kīana¹, **ci-**, n. (III), (of string) loop, slip-knot; small bundle of firewood hung in loops above the wood-pile as reserve; cf. *gīthiari*, *kīririmithario*.

(**ri-**) **maana**, n. (III), 1. larva of bee in honeycomb. 2. part of comb containing larvae; see *mwana*.

mwana¹, **ci-**, n. cl. 1/8 (III), 1. child, baby, young human being; young girl, girl of any age; ~ *wa Ngai*, child of God, child born with one limb missing; cf. *kūgū*; *kaī kūragitwo* ~ *wa Ngai?* (said when rain has gone on all day without sign of stopping) can it be that someone has killed God's child?; ~ *wa ira*, child of yesterday, lacking in experience; ~ *no ta ūria ūngī*, one child is just as (dear as) another; ~ *aakuire nyina agikima*, (said when asking for a taste) a child died while his mother was mashing food; see *mūunduri*. 2. (cl. 8) progeny of human beings, young ones, descendants; *ciana cia* (*Gikūyū na*) *Mūūmbi*, (children of G. and M.) the Kikuyu tribe. **kīana²**, **ci-**, n. (mainly of animals) young; see *ciana* above. **kīmwana**, **i-**, n. young fellow, recently initiated youth (not a full member of the young warrior group); (coll. among young men) mate, buddy. **kaana**, **tw-**, n. (a term of endearment) lass, lad, young one, small child; ~ *ka rūnyondo* (*rūkenge*), baby. **kamwana**, **tū-**, dim.; see *kīmwana* above. **wana**, n. cl. 14, childhood; *ria* ~, see under *ria*.

anakaha, v.i. (II), 1. appear youthful, renew one's youth, become rejuvenated; (of a patched garment) be renovated; (of an animal's coat) be renewed. 2. adorn oneself with war or fighting gear; cf. *īcūgūra*, *īgaka*. **anaanakaha**, dim. **anakahanga**, diff. **anakahania**, caus. rec. make each other, others, appear youthful; adorn others. **anakahanira**, assoc. 1. become youthful together. 2. put

on fighting gear to use against each other. **anakahia**, caus. make youthful, adorn; rejuvenate; renew, renovate. **īanakahia**, refl. caus. restore oneself to a youthful appearance, adorn oneself. **anakahika**, st. pot. **anakahira**, app. become youthful in appearance, at, for; adorn oneself with fighting gear because of.

mwanake, **a-**, n. (IV), young unmarried man, initiated youth; *mūndū* ~, an ideal young man; ~ *wa muumo*, recently initiated man; *mūthuri* ~, a lively elder; *ūyū nī* ~ *wakwa*, this is my grown-up (unmarried) son; *ndūma ya* ~, biggest pieces of arrowroot with dark-green leaves. ~ *nī kienyū kia Ngai*, a young man is a chip of God. Cf. *muumo*. **kamwanake**, **tū-**, n. 1. youth of warrior class. 2. small young man. **nyanake**, ~, n. lad, initiated youth. **wanake**, n. 1. young manhood, youthfulness, youth. 2. adornments, display, characteristics of young manhood. [see *anakaha*]

-anake, a. (III), youthful, lively, vigorous; cf. *-ithi*. [see *anakaha*]

kīanana [*kīanaana*], **ci-**, n. (VIII), young, immature person; halfling. [*ana*]

ananga, v.t. (II), spoil, ruin, deface; destroy, waste, ravage; cf. *unanga*. **anangana**, rec. waste each other, others, destroy each other. **ananganira**, app. rec. **ananganiria**, caus. app. waste together, destroy at the same time. **anangithia**, d. caus. cause to be wasted, ruined, destroyed; help to waste or ruin. **anangika**, st. pot. be, become, wasted, devastated, destroyed; be destroyable. **anangikira**, app. st. pot. become wasted, ruined, destroyed, at, because of. **anangira**, app. destroy, ruin, waste, at, for, because of.

wanangi, n. cl. 14 (III), spoiling, destruction. [*ananga*].

mwanangiko, **mī-**, n. (III), spoiling, ruining, destruction, defacement, disfigurement. [*ananga*]

mwananirio, **mī-**, n. (I), (of many beasts) bleating, lowing. [*ana*]

mwani, n. (III), 1. term of affection used by women; *mwari wa* ~, my dear. 2. greeting between women one of whom has a son married to the other's daughter. 3. *wa* ~, nickname for hyena.

ania², v.t. (I), hold out, prepare (sth.)